



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

akṣavardhiraśālākādyair devanaṃ jihmakāritam | 17.001a

paṇakrīḍā vayobhiś ca padaṃ dyūtasamāhvayam || 1 || 17.001c

sabhikaḥ kārayed dyūtaṃ deyaṃ dadyāc ca tatkr̥tam | 17.002a

daśakaṃ tu śataṃ vṛddhis tasya syād dyūtakāritā || 2 || 17.002c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 16, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Nāradaśmṛti, in this passage, addresses the ancient practice of gambling, referred to as "dyūta," encompassing games of chance involving dice, wagering, and other forms of playful risk. This wasn't merely a casual pastime; it was a formal activity often conducted under the supervision of a "sabhika," a kind of gambling master or organizer. The scripture acknowledges its existence within society, rather than outright condemning it, and seeks to regulate it. The verses highlight the importance of honoring debts incurred through gambling, suggesting a system where losses were recognized as legitimate obligations. A key aspect is the mention of a potential interest rate of ten percent per hundred, indicating the presence of financial structures associated with gambling activities.

But what does this seemingly archaic discussion of dice and debts mean for you today? It's not about encouraging gambling, but about understanding the underlying principles at play. The concept of "dyūta" can be seen as a metaphor for any situation where you are taking a risk, be it in your career, relationships, or investments. The "sabhika" represents those who facilitate or guide you in these ventures, perhaps advisors or mentors. The emphasis on honoring debts, both literal and metaphorical, underscores the importance of integrity and responsibility in all your dealings. When you engage in any activity involving risk, you are essentially entering a "dyūta." The Nāradaśmṛti reminds you to be mindful of the potential consequences, to act with transparency and fairness, and to uphold your commitments, regardless of the outcome. Recognize the inherent risks in life's gambles, and proceed with awareness, ensuring that your actions are guided by dharma, not simply by chance or desire for gain. It's about playing the game of life with awareness and integrity.

The passage also invites introspection on your relationship with risk. Are you prone to impulsive decisions? Do you understand the potential consequences of your choices? Are you prepared to accept responsibility for the outcomes, both positive and negative? By reflecting on these questions, you can gain a deeper understanding of your own tendencies and cultivate a more balanced and mindful approach to navigating the uncertainties of life. The wisdom lies not in avoiding risk altogether, but in engaging with it consciously and ethically.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are the risks you are currently taking aligned with your values and long-term goals, or are you driven by fleeting desires?